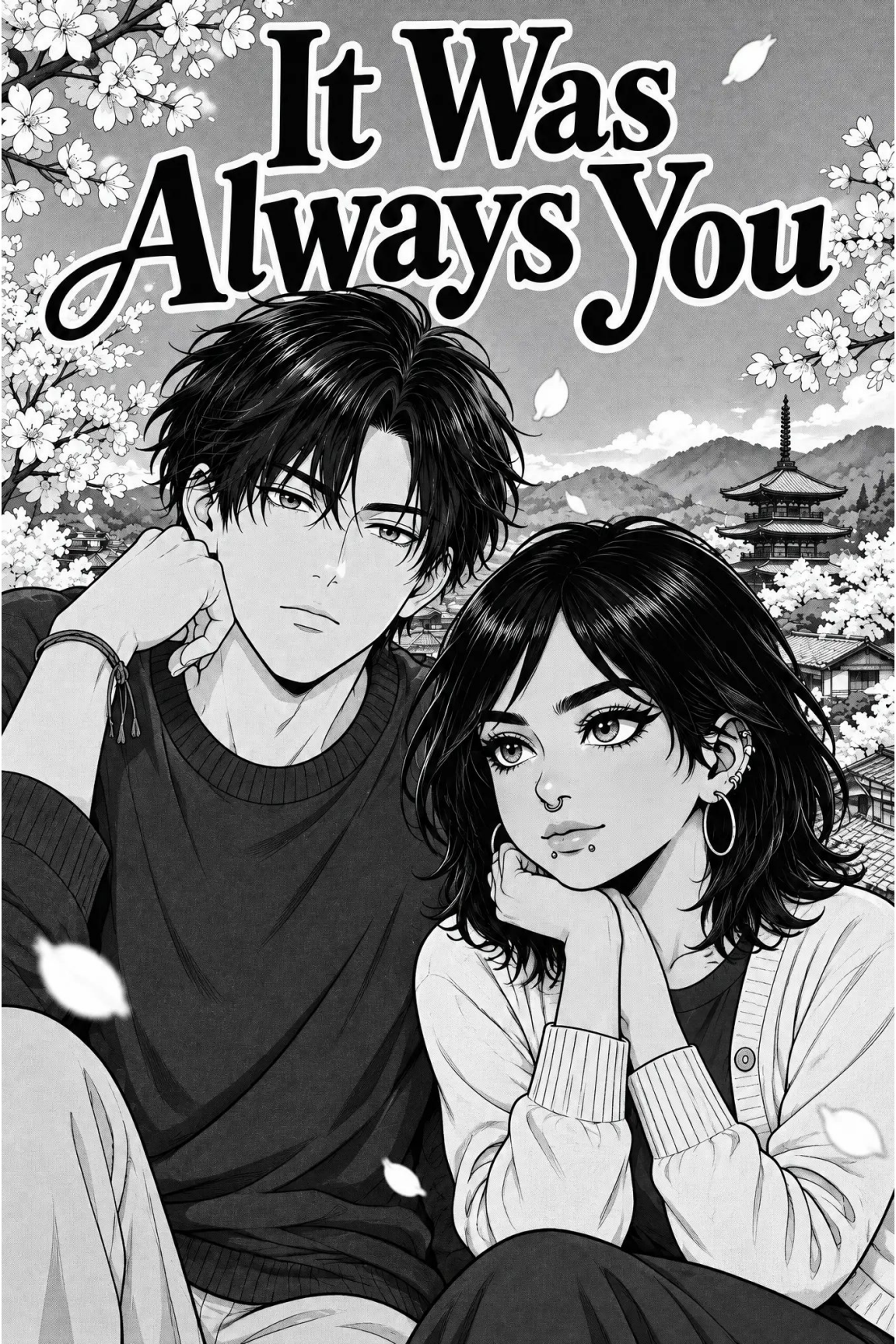

It Was
Always You


Some people fall in love once.
Some fall in love twice.
You never take that off.


It's old. That's all.
Old as in "from your first love"?
...A long time ago, someone saved my life. I never got to thank her properly.
Five hundred years... and she's still the one he thinks about.
But she's the past. You're here.


Her name was Eve
She lived a good, long life. I watched over her village until the end.
Then I'm glad she saved you.
Even if part of me wishes it had been me.


"Wear it when you are ready to meet the one it belongs to..
Ah — no, no... Sorry, Grandma.
tik
There. Ready.
FWOOOSH


Where… where am I?
THWIP!
The fox went this way! It's bleeding — it won't get far!
A fox…?


...Eve?


Get out, human. Or I'll tear your throat open.
You can barely sit up.
RRRIP
...Why?
Because you're going to live. That's an order.


Humans hunt my kind for sport. You're no different.
You'll meet one who is. Someday. I promise.
Tch. Don't make promises you can't keep.
Even five hundred years ago, he's this stubborn.


...Tell me your name.
If I tell him, will everything change?


...You'll learn it when it matters.


Oh! I — I saw blood by the door...
CREEEAK


He's hurt, and a hunter is looking for him. Can you keep him hidden for a few days?
My father keeps this barn. Nobody comes here but me.
When he wakes, give him this. Tell him: "Live." He'll understand.


CRACK
Found you...
Stay with him. Don't make a sound.
There you are!

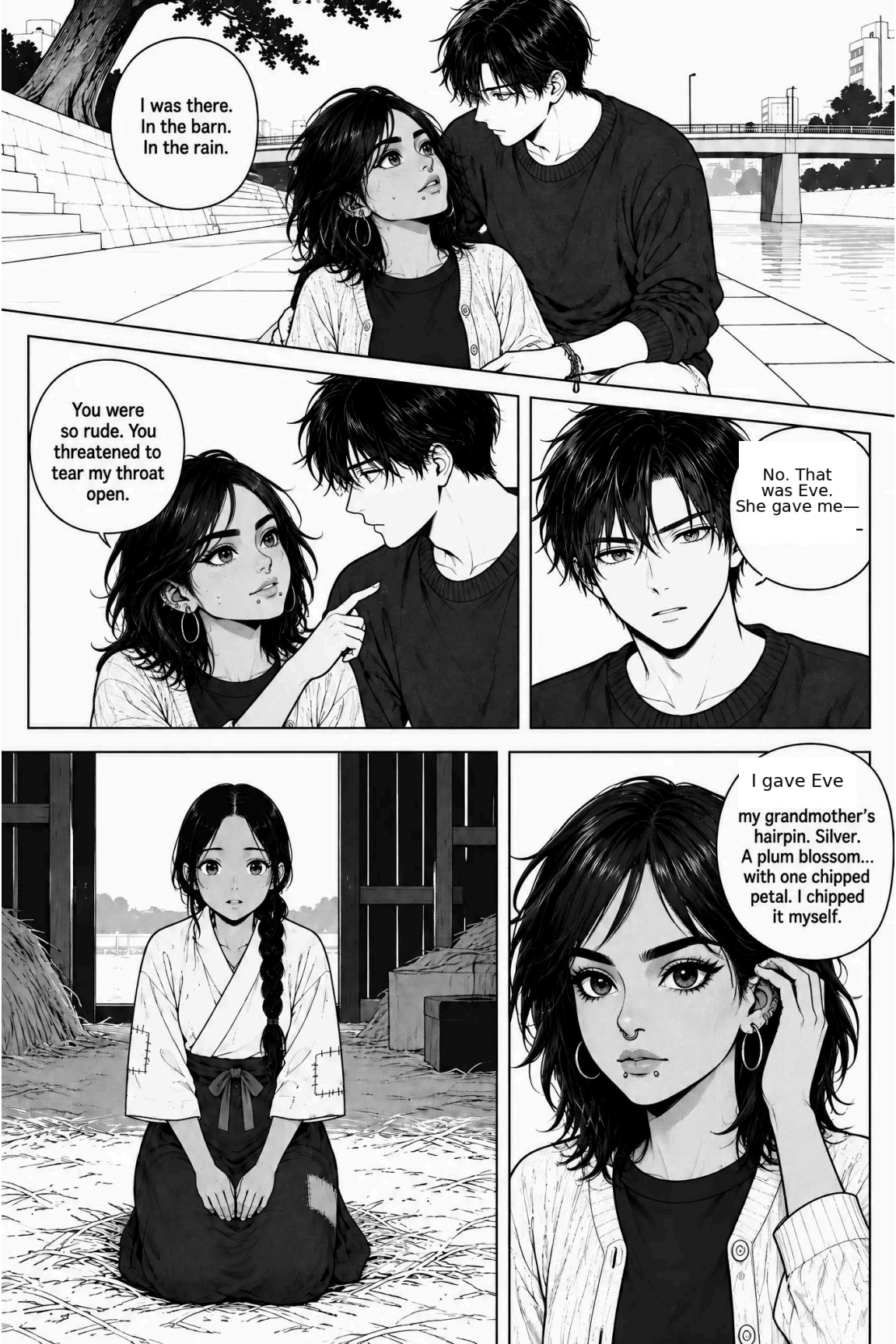

...A girl? Where is the fox?
Far away from you.
KRSSH—


...Where is she?
She said to give you this. She said... 'Live.'
...It was you. You saved me.


And so he loved the wrong name... for five hundred years.


EVE!
TAP
TAP
TAP
The workshop was empty — your grandmother's case was open — I've been searching all night—
You're going to live. That's an order.


...What did you just say?


I was there.
In the barn.
In the rain.
You were so rude. You threatened to tear my throat open.
No. That was Eve. She gave me—
I gave Eve
my grandmother's hairpin. Silver. A plum blossom... with one chipped petal. I chipped it myself.


...It's mine.
It always was.




But it was you.
It was always you.
Five hundred years...
I thought I was keeping my heart for someone else.
And I spent all this time being jealous of myself.


Thank you for saving me. Both times.
Some people fall in love twice. He fell in love with the same girl... across five hundred years.
THE END
End of Chapter 1: It Was Always You